

Mtech Software Engineering

Software Product Management

Assignment 2 - Group AD



To validate the core value and usability of the product's MVP features by testing a low-fidelity prototype with real users.

Group Members:

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Introduction :

The Underserved Need for Empowered Mental Wellness -The Market Landscape:
A Generation Under Pressure India has the world's largest population of young people. This generation is ambitious and tech-savvy, but also faces a major mental health crisis. A recent report showed that a staggering 80% of India's workforce struggles with mental health issues. Young professionals aren't looking for a label or a diagnosis; they are actively seeking sophisticated tools that build resilience, sharpen their focus, and give them a competitive advantage.

Origin	of	the	Product:	Mind	Play
Theme:	Neurological	intent,	gamified	mental	well-being
Tagline: A journey through meditative play					

Product Idea & Target Customer

The product is MindPlay , a holistic "Mental Fitness" platform. It is designed as a mental health platform that provides personalized programs by combining neurological brain games with a strength-based pre-assessment.

The product is scientifically rooted in Neuroplasticity , which is the brain's ability to reorganize itself by forming new neural pathways. It delivers bite-sized, gamified sessions that fit into busy schedules and uses a low-friction reward system to encourage consistency. The platform aims to be a "trusted front-door to complete mental well-being" by offering a gamified development program, mental health assessments, and access to both 1-on-1 and group therapy with vetted professionals.

The target market is broken down into B2C and B2B segments.

B2C Customers: This group includes "Ambitious, tech savvy individuals" and students who are in competitive, high-stress environments such as tech, finance, law, or entrepreneurship. These users are described as data-driven and prone to "Brain-fog" , anxiety, or burnout. The "Early Adopters" are defined as tech-savvy professionals aged 24-35 with disposable income, working in high-stress jobs and living in Tier 1 or Tier 2 cities.

B2B Customers: This segment consists of "Mid to Large Corporations" , startups , and "Educational institutions" like universities and business schools. These organizations are seeking to provide mental health services to their employees or students to increase productivity, support mental health, and enhance performance.

Underserved Needs & Value Proposition

Underserved Needs:

The target customers face **significant Mental Fatigue & Burnout**, where long work hours and constant digital exposure actively **reduce their focus and memory**. This directly leads to low productivity, procrastination, and potential career setbacks. The problem is compounded by existing **Passive & Unengaging Solutions**.

Conventional stress-relief methods are perceived as temporary and ineffective, while meditation and journaling apps feel repetitive and are hard to sustain. This is largely because they lack interactive feedback, which makes personal progress feel invisible, causing users to quickly lose motivation and abandon the tools. Finally, these individuals experience high Performance Anxiety. Intense competition pushes them to constantly chase improvement, but this fuels a fear of underperforming, stress, and self-doubt. **The current wellness tools on the market fail to address this, as they do not align with the users' underlying ambition or career growth goals**

Value Proposition:

We believe mental well-being should be about unlocking potential, not just solving problems. Mind Play is built on this principle. We provide a positive and engaging platform where users discover and build upon their innate cognitive strengths, using 'mental fitness' as a foundation to achieve lasting resilience and personal growth. By framing wellness as “**mental fitness**,” it shifts the narrative from “what’s wrong with me?” to “how can I unlock my potential?”—helping users discover their cognitive superpowers, strengthen resilience, and achieve well-being from a foundation of strength.

Storymap

Activities	Onboarding & Profile Setup	Therapy Session Management	Self-Help & Wellness Tools	Community & Peer Support	Progress Tracking & Insights	Therapist & Health Analysis Tools	Corporate Wellness
Tasks	Register & Login	Search Therapists	Mood Log	Join Groups	Mood Graphs	Notes	Dashboards
	Fill Questionnaire	Book Sessions	Exercises	Chat	Reports	Summaries	Programs
	Personalize Goals	Reschedule	Sleep/Stress Tracking	Forums	AI Predictions	Symptom Analysis	Crisis Support
		Payments					
Release 1	Register with login/social auth	Search & book therapist sessions	Daily mood check-in	Join anonymous peer groups	Simple progress tracking (charts)		
	Fill mental health questionnaire	Secure payment & reminders	Smart habit-building tools				
Release 2	Personalized therapy goals	Reschedule/cancel sessions	Guided meditations & coping exercises	Moderated peer forums	Weekly AI-generated wellness reports	Therapist notes & structured recommendations	Corporate HR dashboards
Release 3	Filter by gender, specialization, language			Group therapy sessions	Burnout & relapse alerts (AI-driven)	Emotional tone detection from text/voice	Wellness challenges for corporate users
Backlog		VR/AR immersive therapy sessions	Integration with wearables		Predictive relapse prevention models	Crisis alerting system	

Mind Play - MVP Features & Justification

1. Register & Login (with Social Auth option)	What it is: A secure, low-friction user-facing "front door." Users can create an account using their email or, more importantly, a one-tap social provider (like Google or Apple).	Why it's MVP: This feature is the gateway to personalization . Without an account, we cannot save a user's questionnaire results, track their game progress, or build their "Mind Garden." The <i>social auth</i> part is critical for an MVP because it drastically reduces signup friction, testing our hypothesis that an "easy first step" is key to overcoming initial user hesitation.
2. Fill Mental Health Questionnaire	What it is: The "strength-based pre-assessment" that forms the user's initial profile. This is not a clinical "what's wrong with you?" test. Instead, it asks positive questions to identify the user's cognitive strengths, personality traits, and wellness goals.	Why it's MVP: This feature is our Unique Value Proposition in action. It directly tests the hypothesis: "Will users be more willing to engage with a mental wellness app that focuses on their <i>strengths</i> rather than their <i>disorders</i> ?" The output of this quiz is essential to personalize the games, making the experience relevant from day one

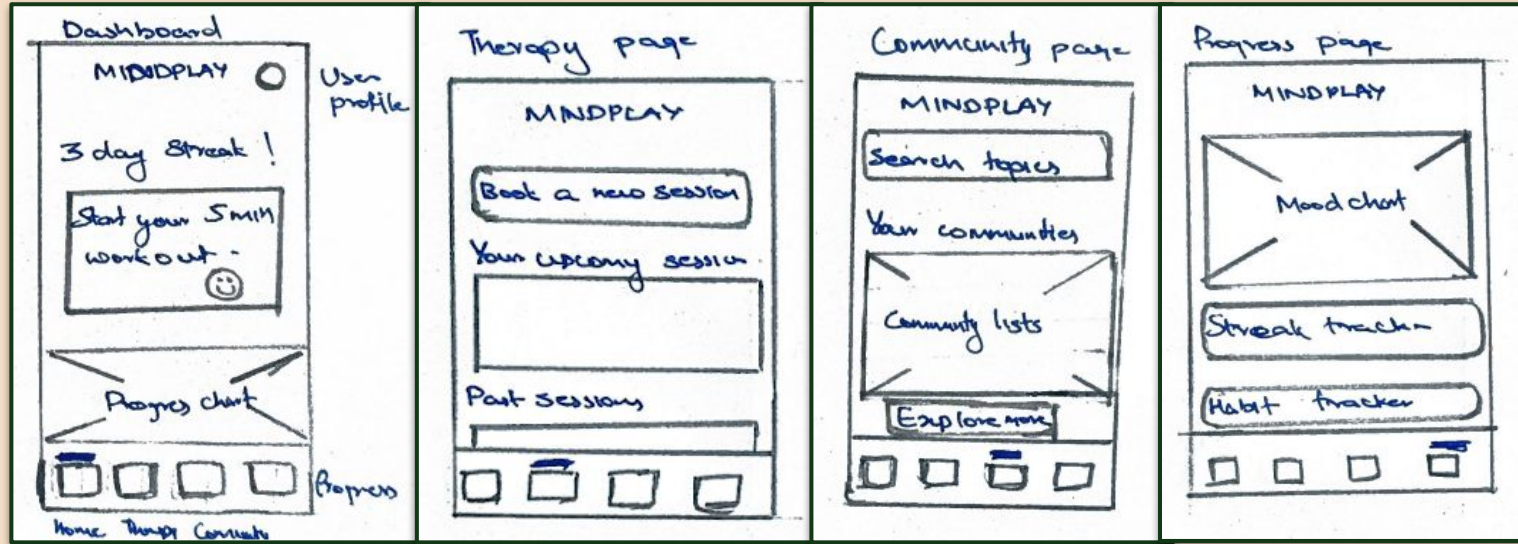
3.Strength-Based Neurological Games (Bite-sized Sessions)	What it is: The core "gamified mental well-being" loop. The MVP will include 2-3 simple, "bite-sized" games (e.g., 5 minutes) that are directly recommended based on the user's questionnaire results (e.g., a "focus" game for someone who wants to reduce distraction).	Why it's MVP: This tests our "meditative play" tagline. The hypothesis is: "Are engaging, science-backed games a more effective hook for <i>long-term consistency</i> than traditional, passive meditation apps?" This feature is the primary "action" the user takes and the main solution to the "boring" and "stigma" problems
4. Reward System (The "Mind Garden")	What it is: A visual, intrinsic reward system for consistency. As you suggested, this isn't just points. We'll call it the "Mind Garden."	Why it's MVP: This feature directly tests the "habit-building" hypothesis. Mental wellness requires consistency, which is the hardest part for users. This garden concept provides a powerful <i>intrinsic</i> (personal growth, visual beauty) and <i>extrinsic</i> (streaks, collection) motivator to get users to return daily.
5. Search & Book Therapist Sessions	What it is: This is the bridge from "wellness" to "care." A simple, curated directory where users can view therapist profiles (vetted by us), see their specialties, and book a session.	Why it's MVP: This tests the most critical business model and trust hypothesis: "Will users who are drawn in by stigma-free <i>games</i> trust the <i>same platform</i> to book <i>real therapy</i>?" If users play games but never book sessions, the "holistic journey" is broken

Low-Fidelity Sketch by Kiran K Das - 2025TM93130

LOGIN PAGE	Profile setup 1	Profile setup 2	Profile setup 3	Profile setup 4
MINDPLAY Email address Password Login <u>Forgot Password?</u> Don't have an account Sign Up Ⓢ Ⓟ	MINDPLAY Welcome! Let's personalise your mindplay journey GET STARTED	MINDPLAY What brings you here? ☐ Reduce stress ☐ Improve sleep ☐ Build habits ☐ Manage anxiety ☐ Book therapy Next →	MINDPLAY How are you feeling generally. ☹ ☹ ☹ ☹ ☹ —●— Next →	MINDPLAY Set a daily reminder CLOCK For mood tracking ☐ For habit tracking ☐ GO TO DASHBOARD

The primary focus of this solution is on the user onboarding experience. It begins with a standard login page, followed by a four-step onboarding process that guides users through personalizing their experience by selecting their well-being goals, indicating their general mood, and setting daily reminders for mood and habit tracking before proceeding to the main dashboard.

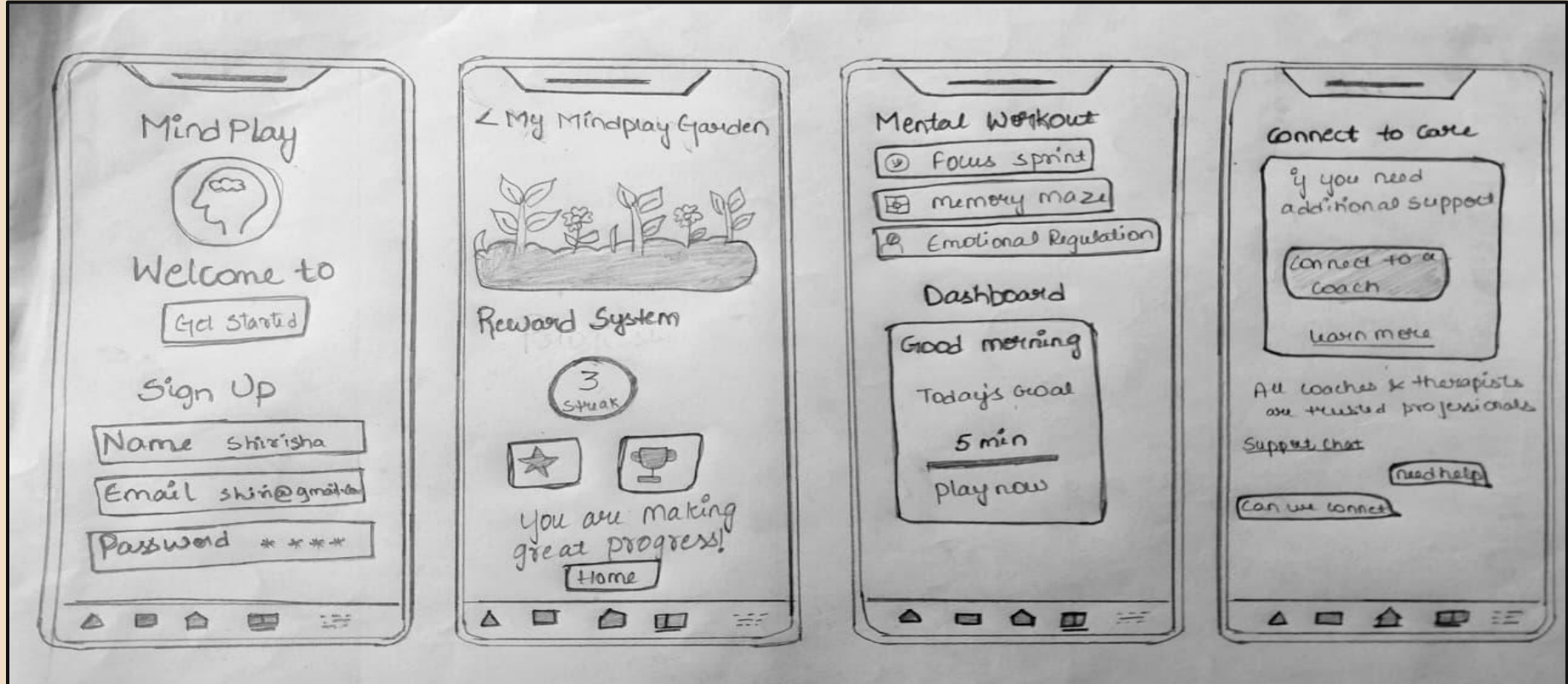
Low-Fidelity Sketch- Kiran K Das - 2025TM93130 (Cont..)



Moving on from the onboarding experience, these slides detail the rest of the core functionality of the app. It contains a dashboard highlighting a current streaks and a prominent "Start your 5 MIN workout" button alongside a progress chart; a therapy page for booking and managing sessions; a community page enabling topic search and interaction within user-specific or general communities; and a progress page displaying mood charts, streak tracking, and habit tracking, all consistently accessible via a bottom navigation bar.

Low-Fidelity Sketch by Shirisha Salandri-2025TM93131

Demonstrates core features — *Mind Garden reward system, daily goals dashboard, and coach connection option.*



Low-Fidelity Sketch by Shirisha Salandri-2025TM93131(Cont...)

Demonstrates core features — *Mind Garden reward system, daily goals dashboard, and coach connection option.*

This Low-Fidelity Wireframe Storyboard represents the early concept of the *MindPlay* mobile app, designed to support mental wellness through engaging daily activities. The first screen introduces the user to *MindPlay* with a simple sign-up process, ensuring quick onboarding. Once inside, the user enters the “**MindPlay Garden**”, a **reward-based system** where progress is visualized through growing plants — symbolizing mental growth and consistency. Each completed task or streak adds to the user’s garden, providing a sense of achievement and motivation.

The next screens display the core MVP features: *Mental Workouts, Dashboard, and Connect to Care*. The *Mental Workout* section includes short, focused exercises like “Focus Sprint,” “Memory Maze,” and “Emotional Regulation.” The *Dashboard* sets small daily goals to make mental training achievable in short bursts. Finally, *Connect to Care* allows users to reach out to certified coaches or therapists for additional help, supported by an in-app chat option. Together, these features form a complete flow—from self-guided growth to professional support—making MindPlay both accessible and supportive for users seeking holistic mental wellness.

Low-Fidelity Sketch- Sunanda Pandita-2025TM93132

Gamified Learning Path for MindPlay

Each level represents a state of mind development rather than just app progress.

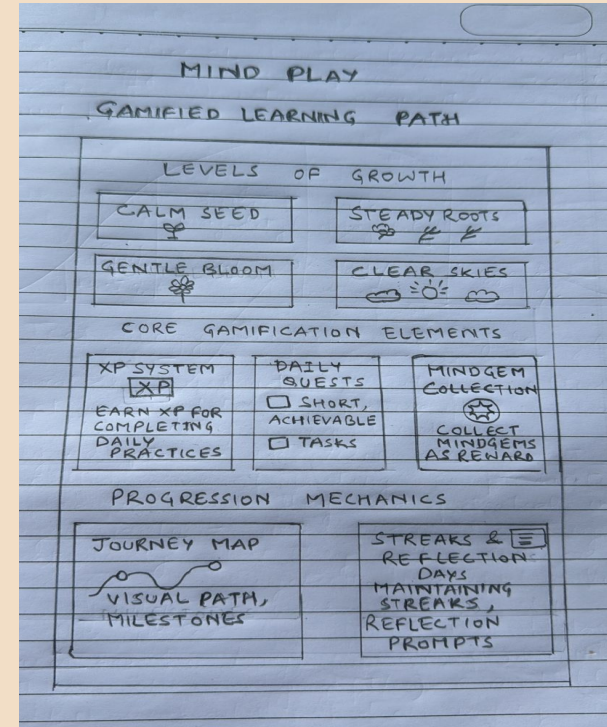
Level 1: Calm Seed, Introduction to mindfulness, Guided breathing, gratitude journaling, Daily streak tracker

Level 2: Steady Roots, Emotional regulation, Mood tracking, grounding exercises, Mood journal customization

Level 3: Gentle Bloom, Building empathy & self-compassion
Loving-kindness meditations “Kindness Quest” mini challenges

Level 4: Clear Skies, Managing anxiety & thoughts, Cognitive reframing mini-games, Access to “Mind Challenges”

Level 5: Balanced Mind, Routine building & resilience, Habit loops, mindful routines, Community milestones & reflection rewards



Low-Fidelity Sketch- Sunanda Pandita-2025TM93132 (Cont..)

2. Core Gamification Elements XP (Experience Points) System. Users earn XP for completing daily practices (e.g., 10 XP for breathing session, 20 XP for journaling). XP unlocks new mindfulness tools and themes.

Daily Quests: Short, achievable tasks like. Take 3 mindful breaths before breakfast.” “List 3 things that made you smile today. Completing 3 quests/day unlocks a “MindGem” — a collectible symbolizing personal

growth. MindGems Collection: Each MindGem represents a wellness skill:

Calmness, Awareness, Compassion, Energy

Collect all to unlock “Mind Balance Mode”, a guided multi-day challenge.

3. Progression Mechanics: Journey Map Visual “path” with milestones: Users see their progress as a tree growing or a mountain being climbed. Each stage corresponds to emotional or mental mastery. Streaks & Reflection Days Maintain streaks for consistent habits. After every 7-day streak → “Reflection Day” with prompts: AI Coach Companion: Provides gentle nudges and celebrates progress.

4. Reward System

5. Social and Community Layer

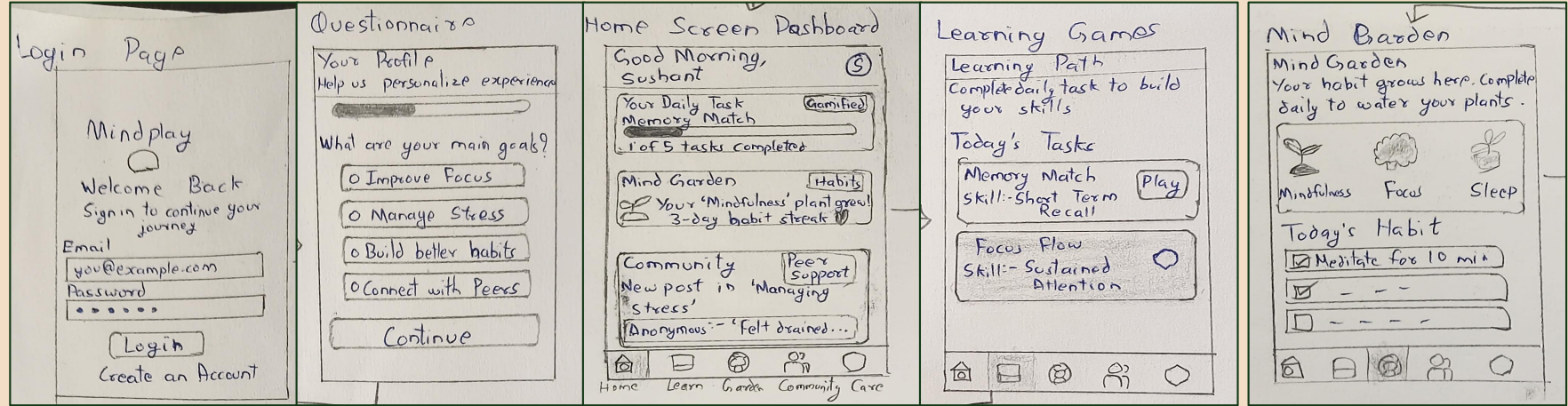
Mind Circles: small, private groups (optional) to share milestones or gratitude moments.

Low-Fidelity Sketch- Rahul-2025TM93133

“Personalized Cognitive Wellness — From Mind Scan to Guided Care”

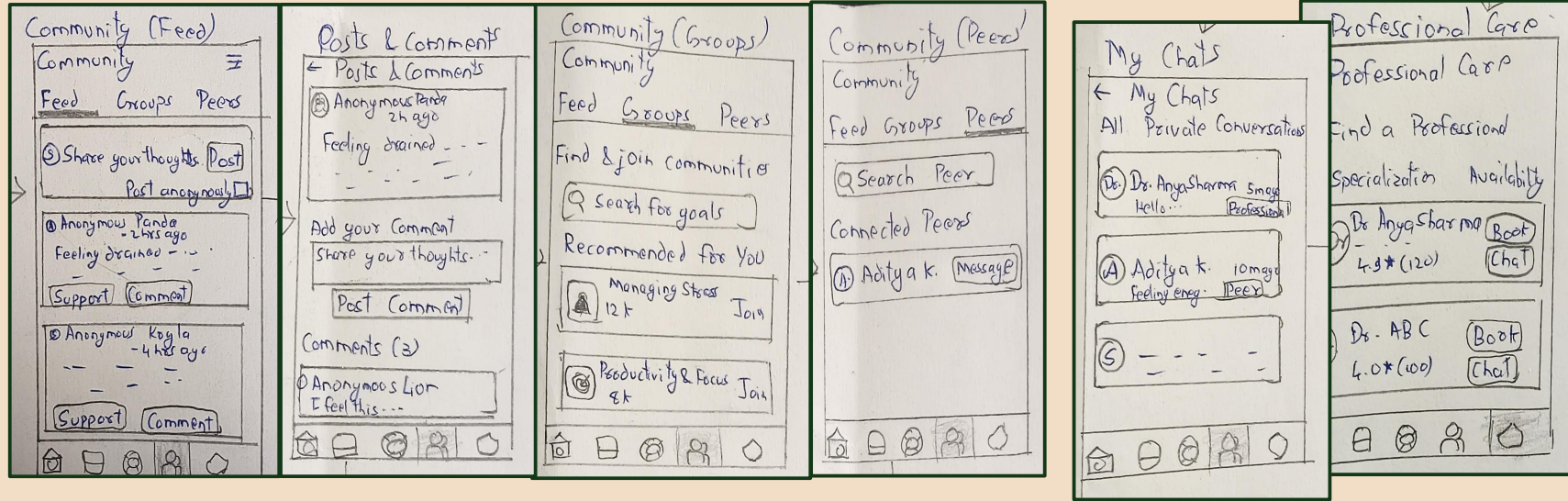
MIND SCAN REPORT	ADAPTIVE ACTIVITY FEED	CARE
STRENGTHS STRONG LOGICAL REASONING AREAS FOR GROWTH IMPROVE CONTEXT SWITCHING	GAME GAME BREATHING EXERCISE HOW DID THAT EXERCISE MAKE YOU FEEL?	FIND YOUR MENTAL FITNESS COACH Q SPECIALIZATION LANGUAGE  BOOK SESSION BOOK SESSION DATE COACHNAME

Low Fidelity Sketch- Sushant Chaudhari-2025TM93134



The primary focus of this low-fidelity wireframe for **MindPlay**, a health and fitness tracking application, is on **Peer and Community Support**. The user journey begins with the **Login Page**, followed by a **Questionnaire** that helps analyze the user's primary goals and tailor personalized plans accordingly. The **Home Screen Dashboard** then provides an overview of daily tasks, games, and community posts. Next, the **Games Page** showcases various activities and challenges that contribute to task completion. Then, the **Mind Garden** feature assigns tasks, and as users complete them, they experience progress and growth within the application.

Low Fidelity Sketch- Sushant Chaudhari-2025TM93134



The primary focus for this page is on the **Peer and Community Support** feature. The wireframe first displays the **Community Feed**, where users can view posts, share their thoughts, and engage with others. It then presents the **Post and Comments** interface, illustrating how users can interact within the community. Moving forward, the wireframe highlights the **Groups or Communities** that users can join based on shared interests. It also includes a **Search and Connect** option, enabling users to find and connect with peers. Additionally, the **Chat Interface** showcases conversations with both peers and professional consultants. Finally, the **Professional Care** section allows users to directly consult with certified professionals for personalized guidance and support.

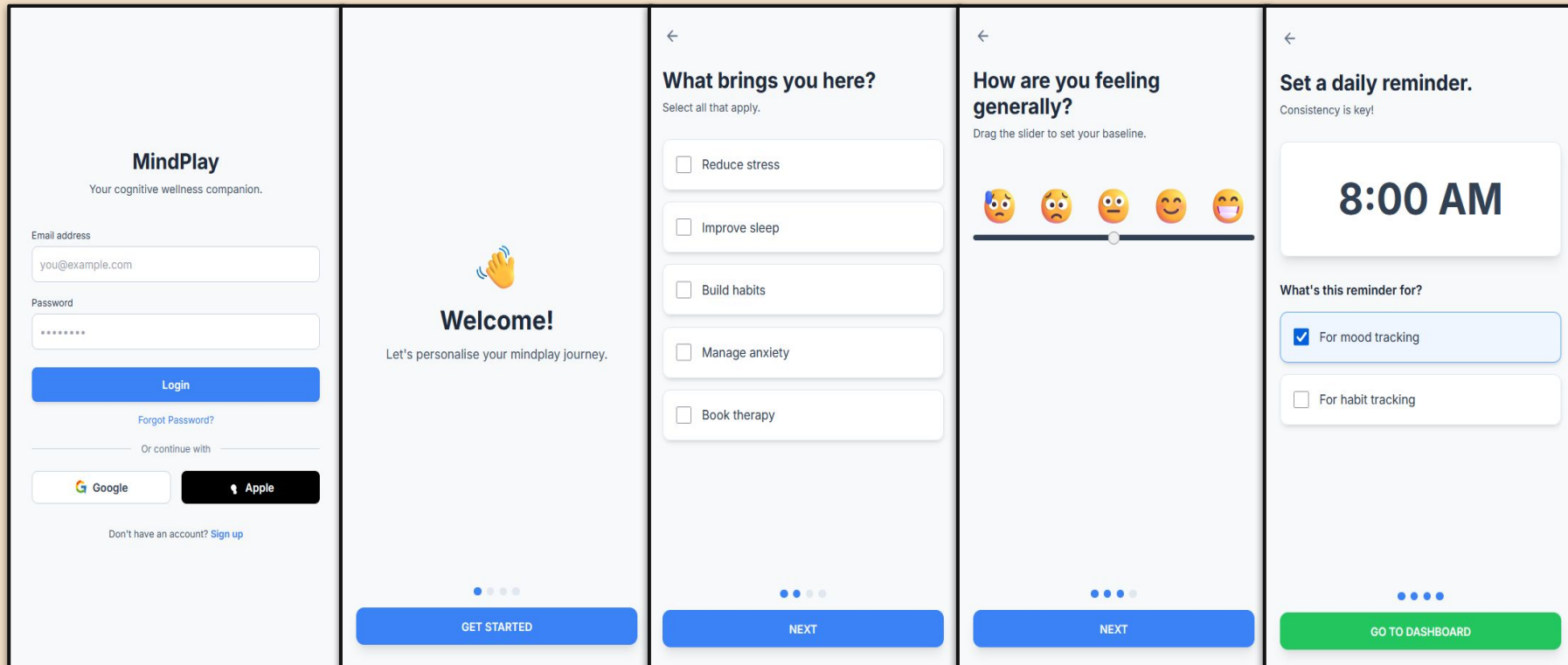
Stand Out Solutions- Converging on a Hybrid Solution

We carried out voting and brainstorming sessions to figure out which solutions had the best approach. It was carried out by giving each voter the ability to cast 3 votes and they can only cast their vote for one idea once. Below are the results:

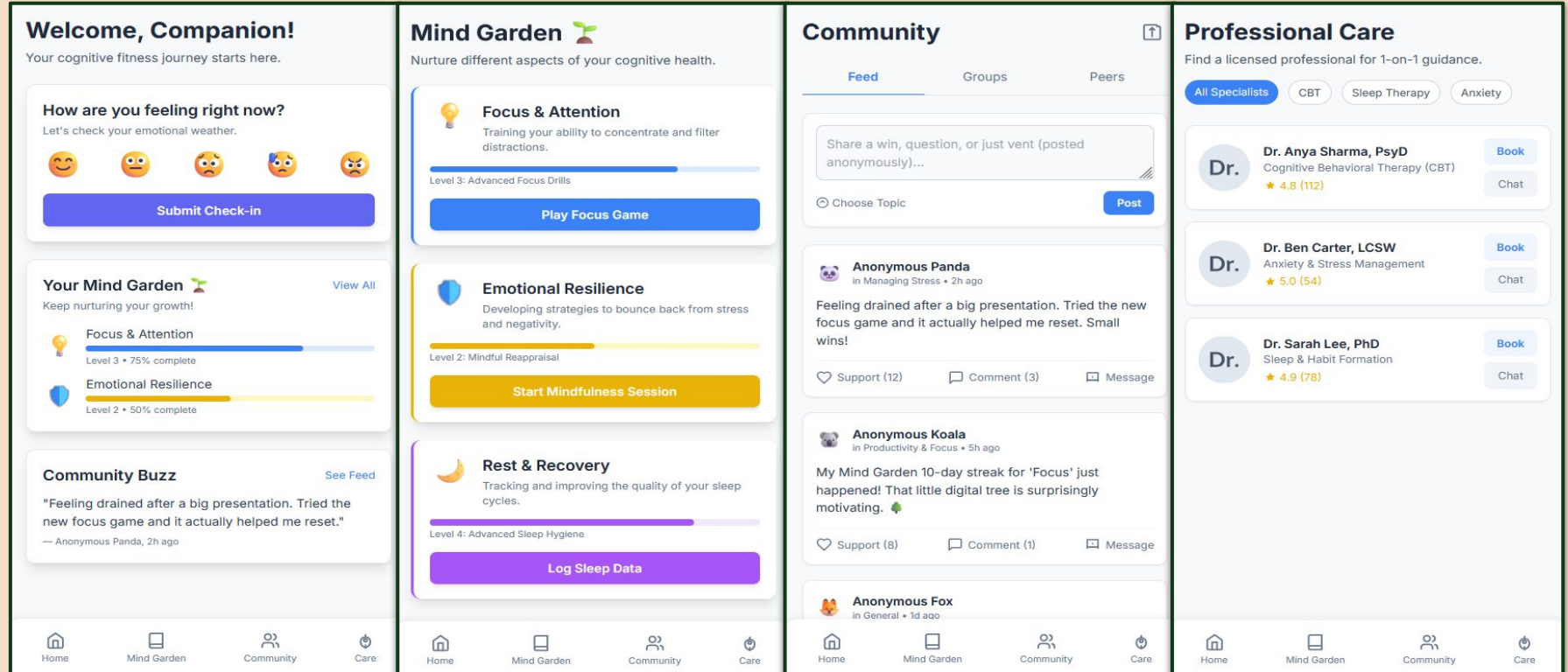
Stand-Out Idea	Votes & sketch #	Analysis & Decision:
Strength-Based Cognitive Profile	5 Votes Sketch 1	"first step. It's the core of our "strength-based"
Mind Garden Reward System	4 Votes Sketch 2	clear stand-out idea,compelling solution for building a daily <i>habit</i>
Gamification Core Loop	3 Votes Sketch 4	"meditative play" the central "action" the user takes.
Care & Consultation Booking Flow	2 Votes Sketch 3	"end-of-funnel" goal. simple flow for finding and booking a therapist validates the "holistic journey"
Community Support	1 Vote Sketch 5	"fast follow." the team prioritized the <i>core user journey</i> (Profile -> Game -> Reward -> Care) for the initial storyboard.

We will develop a unified wireframe storyboard for the "golden path," incorporating the most effective brainstorming ideas. Additional wireframe features will be storyboarded for inclusion in a post-Minimum Viable Product (MVP) release.

Initial wireframe Storyboard



Initial wireframe Storyboard (Cont..)



Customer Interviews & Feedback

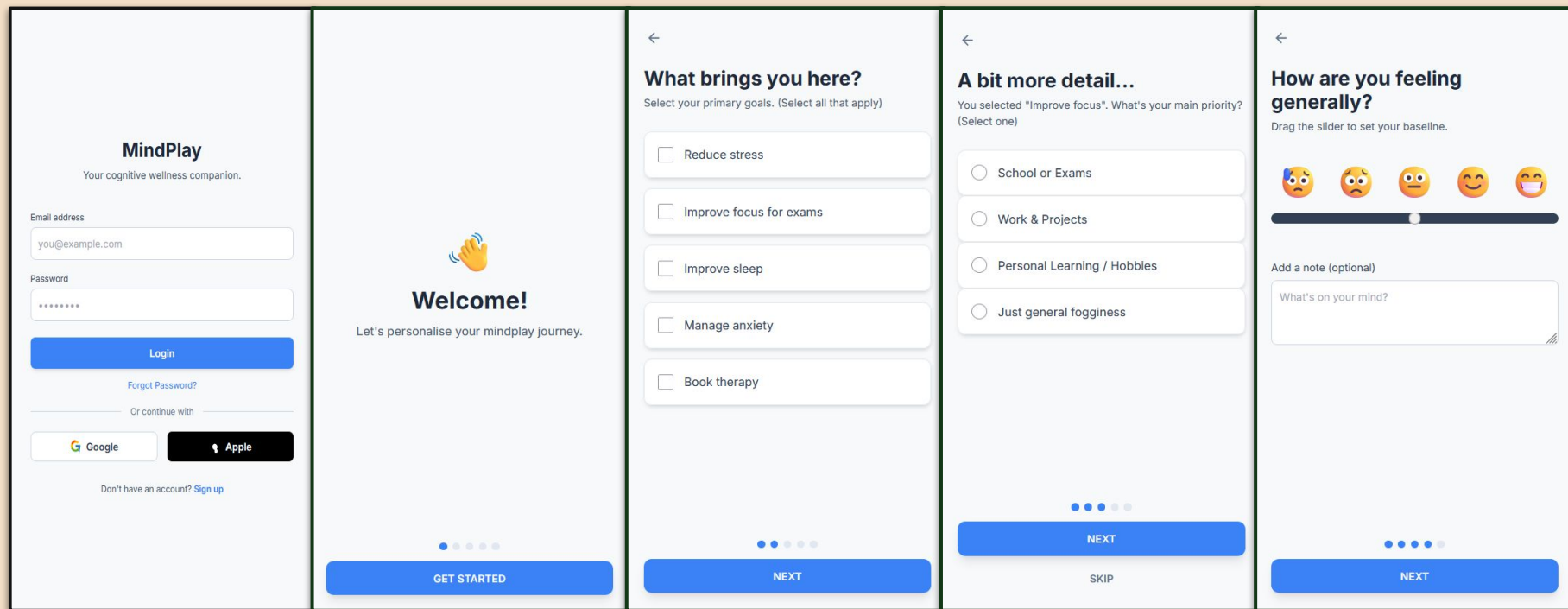
Potential Customer	How do you feel about the 'Mind Garden' growing with your actions? What's most motivating about this gamified approach for you?	What makes you feel safe in an anonymous community? What are your main concerns about using such a feature?	What kind of 'personalized insights' (like the 'Mental Fitness Score' or activity feedback) would be most valuable and actionable for you?	Key Quote
Priya, 26 Marketing Manager	The Mind Garden is cute, but for me, the <i>games</i> need to feel genuinely productive, not just cute. I'm motivated by seeing clear results and improvement from my efforts.	Anonymous forums are a big plus. It makes me feel safe because I don't have to worry about professional perception. My main concern would be ensuring it stays a professional and supportive space.	I love the 'Mental Fitness Score' – it's like tracking my KPIs! That's super valuable. I'd want insights that show me how my activities directly impact that score and my overall productivity.	<i>I love the 'Mental Fitness Score' – it's like tracking my KPIs! But the games need to feel genuinely productive, not just 'cute'.</i>
Rohan 23, Software Engineer	The gamification with the Mind Garden is a cool idea, makes tracking less like a chore. The 'Daily Tasks' are perfect – bite-sized and clear. I'd want the games to feel genuinely challenging and progressive to 'sharpen my mind,' not just repetitive.	Anonymity is key; I wouldn't want colleagues or connections to see me. I'd feel safe if there's clear moderation and perhaps specific threads for different tech/work-related stresses. Concerned about it becoming a time sink or unmoderated.	I'd want to see precise data on how different exercises impact my focus or cognitive function. The 'Mental Fitness Score' is good, but I'd also want granular insights, perhaps on my reaction times or problem-solving speed improvements.	Meditation feels passive. I want something active that sharpens my mind while I de-stress.

Ankit, Team Lead	30 The 'Daily Workout' concept and gamified progress would resonate well. If it's positioned as enhancing mental performance, that's motivating. I'd be looking for simple, clear progression within the garden.	The anonymous community is smart – no one wants to admit they're struggling, especially in a leadership role. This makes me feel safe to explore. Concerns would be privacy breaches and ensuring the advice given is sound and not just peer venting.	The 'Mental Fitness Score' would be very useful, especially if I could track it over time to see trends. For B2B potential, aggregate, anonymized team analytics would be interesting (e.g., team-wide stress levels, not individual data).	The 'Mental Fitness Score' and 'Daily Workout' would definitely resonate with my team for performance enhancement. The anonymous community is smart – no one wants to admit struggling.
Arohi Student	20, The Mind Garden makes everything feel less serious, which is a good thing when I'm already stressed with studies. Quick 5-minute games between study sessions sound perfect. I'd be motivated by seeing my garden grow and perhaps unlocking new elements.	The anonymous chat is perfect; I wouldn't want my friends to know I'm using a 'mental health' app. I'd feel safe if it's truly private. My concern is dealing with overly negative posts or feeling pressured to share if I'm not ready.	I'd love insights on how my mental exercises impact my study focus or exam performance. Is there a way to track exam-specific progress or stress levels? The 'Mental Fitness Score' could be a good overall indicator of how well I'm coping.	The Mind Garden makes it feel less serious, which is good when I'm stressed. The anonymous chat is perfect; I wouldn't want friends to know.

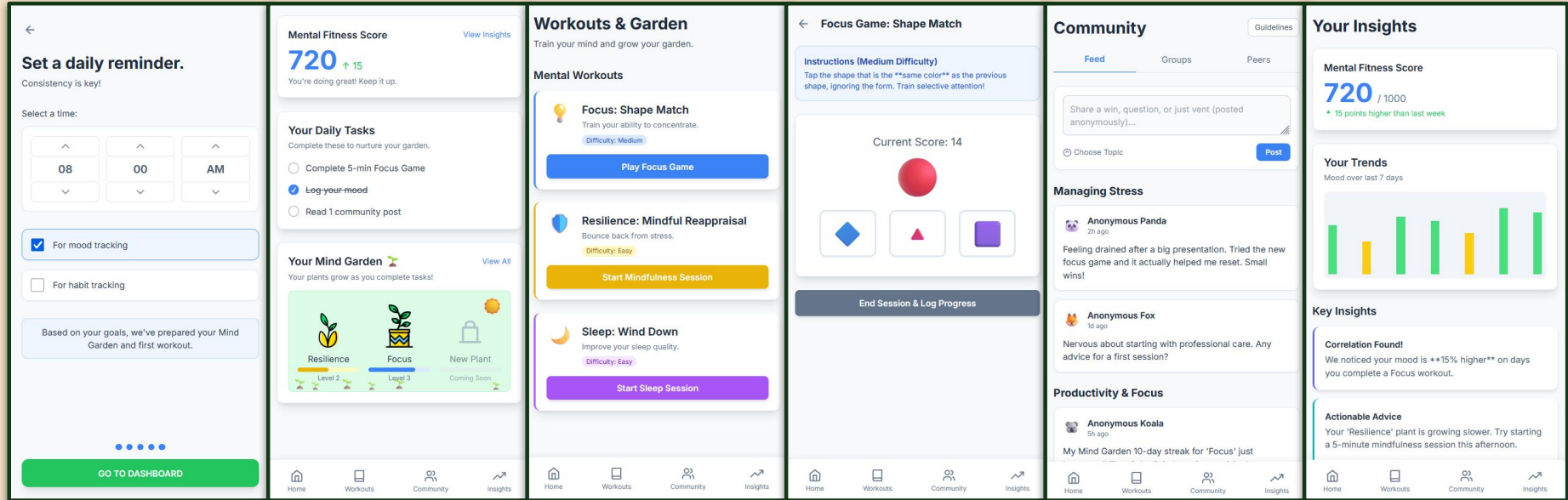
Dileep 66, Retired Professional	I like the idea of growing something visually – it's a calm and manageable way to see my progress. The daily check-in and simple games seem manageable. I'd be motivated by seeing consistent, steady growth in my garden.	I'd feel safe knowing it's anonymous and that I can connect with people facing similar life changes. It's good not to have to use my real name. My main concern would be complex navigation or inappropriate content from younger users.	The 'Mental Fitness Score' makes sense; I track my physical steps, so why not my mind? I'd want insights that confirm I'm staying mentally active, perhaps showing improvement in memory or focus over time, presented clearly and not too fast-paced.	The daily check-in and simple games seem manageable. I track my physical steps, so why not my mind with a 'Mental Fitness Score'? I just need the games to be intuitive and not too fast-paced.
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Based on customer feedback, the updated wireframe now focuses on **gamification with purpose**, transforming the Mind Garden dashboard into a more productive tool where visual growth is explicitly tied to completing **concise "Daily Tasks"** and **"Mental Workouts."** These games will offer **varied difficulty levels** to meet demands for both intuitive simplicity and cognitive challenge. The prominent **"Mental Fitness Score"** is now backed by a dedicated **"Insights" section** providing **actionable advice, clear trends, and data-driven correlations** (like mood/activity links) in digestible formats like graphs and cards. Furthermore, the **Anonymous Community** will be restructured with **clear categories/topics, robust moderation**, and an upfront reaffirmation of **privacy guidelines** to ensure a safe, navigable, and supportive environment. Finally, the **onboarding process** will be enhanced with **personalized goal-setting** to tailor the initial Mind Garden and game recommendations to specific user needs, such as exam prep or focus improvement, right from the start.

Modified Wireframe Storyboard



Modified Wireframe Storyboard (Cont..)



Key Learnings - Kiran K Das - 2025TM93130

For me, this product validation assignment provided invaluable insights into the iterative nature of product development and user-centric design. My key takeaways are as follows

- **Strategic MVP Definition:** MVP is not merely a list of features, but a meticulously justified selection addressing the core user problem. The process of critically evaluating and prioritizing features refined my understanding of essential functionality versus 'nice-to-haves' for the initial launch.
- **The Efficacy of Low-Fidelity Prototyping:** Utilizing hand-drawn sketches was an exceptionally effective method for initial generation of the solution. This approach helped rapid ideation and focused discussions on core functionality rather than aesthetics, and enabled efficient consolidation of the strongest MVPs.
- **Indispensable Role of User Feedback:** Engaging directly with target customers was a pivotal learning experience. As experienced in the Assignment 1, user feedback on the wireframe highlighted critical aspects. This direct validation was instrumental in identifying areas for improvement and confirming value propositions.
- **Iteration as a Core Principle:** The project underscored that product development is inherently iterative. Modifying our wireframe based on user feedback was not just a step in the assignment, but a crucial demonstration of how continuous refinement, driven by user input, leads to a more robust and user-aligned product.
- **Clarity and Conciseness in Communication:** Throughout the sketching, documentation, and feedback synthesis phases, the importance of clear, concise communication became evident. Brevity in descriptions and clarity in visual representation were essential for effective team collaboration and eliciting precise user feedback.

Key Learnings - Shirisha Salandri-2025TM93131

1. We found that creating low-fidelity sketches individually(**Power of Parallel Prototyping**) worked far better than traditional group brainstorming. For Mind Play, this produced five unique solutions and encouraged holistic thinking about the user flow. Voting on concrete sketches made idea selection objective—focused on the **best concepts**, not the loudest opinions.
2. A product vision and feature list stay abstract until linked through a storyboard. **Storyboarding Turns Features into a User Journey**. Building the Mind Play wireframe storyboard was when the product truly “came alive.” It revealed how users move from a game to booking a therapist and exposed experience gaps, turning our vision into a testable journey.
3. The main value of prototyping is learning not design perfection. **prototypes are for Learning, Not Building** Showing the Mind Play storyboard to five users gave quick, honest feedback on our assumptions. We learned which parts of our “holistic journey” worked and which confused users—reducing risk before real development.
4. **Experiencing the Build-Measure-Learn Loop**-This assignment simulated the agile Build-Measure-Learn cycle:
 - Build: a low-fidelity storyboard
 - Measure: user testing with 5 participants
 - Learn: iterate from insights

Key Learnings - Sunanda Pandita-2025TM93132

Importance of Emotional Design

- Mental health apps must **evoke calmness and trust** through color, tone, and interaction flow.
- A soothing visual style, gentle animations, and minimal distractions improve user comfort and engagement.

Balance Between Gamification and Sensitivity

- Gamification boosts motivation, but **mental wellness can't feel like a competition**.
- Rewards (like MindGems and levels) should focus on **progress, reflection, and self-growth** rather than points or leaderboards.

Micro-Habits Drive Consistency

- Short, repeatable actions (like 3-minute breathing or gratitude journaling) create sustainable habits.
- Daily streaks and “Reflection Days” encourage mindful repetition without pressure.

Empathy in UX Writing

- Language choices must be **non-judgmental, encouraging, and compassionate**.
- Phrases like “You’re making gentle progress” work better than “You missed your goal.”

Privacy and Trust Are Non-Negotiable

- Users share sensitive thoughts and emotions; hence **data security and confidentiality** are essential.
- Clear privacy dashboards and local data storage options build user confidence.

Cross-Functional Collaboration

- Building MindPlay required collaboration between **psychologists, UX designers, and developers**.
- This ensured scientific grounding while maintaining user-centric design.

Visual Progress Reinforces Motivation

- Showing growth through visuals (e.g., a blooming plant or glowing aura) helps users **see intangible progress** in emotional balance.

Key Learnings- Rahul-2025TM93133

1. **Personalization enhances engagement** — Starting with a “Mind Scan” helps tailor activities, making users feel understood and invested.
2. **Positive framing builds motivation** — Highlighting strengths first (“Start with what’s right”) encourages confidence and continued use.
3. **Adaptive design increases relevance** — Real-time feedback ensures recommendations evolve with the user’s progress and mood.
4. **Seamless integration improves retention** — Combining training, reflection, and professional support creates a holistic mental fitness experience.
5. **Optional reflection drives deeper connection** — Gentle journal prompts promote self-awareness without feeling forced.
6. **Accessible care fosters trust** — The “Care” tab connects users to professionals easily, bridging self-help and guided assistance.
7. **Low-fidelity prototyping clarifies flow early** — Sketching wireframes helped visualize user journeys before high-fidelity design.

Key Learnings - Sushant Chaudhari-2025TM93134

- **Stigma-Free Positioning is Key:** Framing the product around "**Mental Fitness**" and potential (instead of disorder/illness) is crucial for attracting the target young professional market.
- **Holistic Solution Demand:** The product must facilitate the **complete user journey**, connecting gamified daily practice directly to **Therapist Booking** for professional care.
- **Privacy Feature is Essential:** Including **Anonymous Peer Groups** addresses a core user pain point by providing a critical, low-friction, stigma-free support option.
- **Gamification Must Drive Habit:** Rewards must focus on **consistency, reflection, and progress** (e.g., Mind Garden)
- **Progress Must Be Visible:** Simple, easy-to-read **charts and a KPI** (like the Mental Fitness Score) are mandatory to reward user effort and show tangible results, combating the pain point of "invisible progress."
- **Story Map Aided Scope:** Using the **Story Map** was key to clearly defining and limiting the **MVP features** (e.g., deferring complex features) to ensure a fast, focused release.
- **Storyboard Confirmed Flow:** The **Storyboard** helped visualize the emotional user journey, ensuring a non-alarming and seamless transition from wellness game to the sensitive act of booking a therapist.
- **Wireframes Reduced Friction:** **Wireframing** early uncovered critical usability issues, especially in the **Secure Payment/Booking flow**, allowing for simplification before development.
- **Customer Feedback Invalidated Assumptions:** User interviews confirmed the need for **productivity** and **privacy** while showing indifference towards "cute" design elements, guiding the final feature set.

Conclusion

The *MindPlay* product validation exercise successfully demonstrated how structured product management methods can turn an abstract concept into a validated, user-centered solution. Through parallel prototyping, voting, and user testing, our team identified the most impactful features—**the Mind Garden reward system, daily mental workouts, therapist booking flow, and anonymous peer support**—as the foundation of the MVP.

User feedback from five participants confirmed that *MindPlay* **gamified approach, personalized insights, and stigma-free community** strongly resonated with their mental wellness goals. The iterative process helped refine the product into a more purposeful experience—linking every feature to measurable engagement and emotional comfort.

Overall, the assignment reinforced that **effective MVP design is about learning fast, validating assumptions, and improving continuously**. The final low-fidelity storyboard now represents a holistic mental fitness journey—from *self-guided growth* to *professional care*—positioning *MindPlay* as an innovative, accessible, and trusted solution for modern mental wellness.